Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Case Study (Phishing Attack)

Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers try to steal sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or personal data by pretending to be a trusted source. It usually happens through fake emails, messages, or websites that look genuine.

A common phishing scenario works step-by-step like this: - First, the attacker sends an email or message that appears to be from a bank, UPI app, or a well-known company. The message creates urgency, such as “Your account will be blocked” or “You have won a reward.” Next, the victim is asked to click on a link. This link leads to a fake website that looks very similar to the original one. When the user enters their login details or OTP, the attacker captures the information. Finally, the attacker uses these details to access the victim’s account and perform unauthorized transactions.

Students and young users are often targeted because they may not always verify the authenticity of such messages. The consequences can be serious, including financial loss, identity theft and loss of personal data.

Phishing attacks are increasing rapidly, especially with the rise of online payments and digital platforms. Awareness and caution are the most important ways to prevent such cybercrimes.